

Eight Wastes (TIMWOODS) in the Support Process

Background

Lean thinking defines 8 common wastes, often remembered as TIMWOODS: Transportation, Inventory, Motion, Waiting, Overproduction, Overprocessing, Defects, and Skills. These are activities the customer does not want to pay for. [web:599][web:549][web:546]

Table of Wastes Observed

Waste	Example in Our Process	Impact on AHT
Transportation	Copying information from one system to another instead of automatic sync.	Adds 30–60 seconds on some calls.
Inventory	“Parking” partially resolved tickets that then need re-reading later.	Creates rework and extra handling time.
Motion	Agents moving between many screens and tabs during a call.	Slows down research and increases risk of errors.
Waiting	Agents and customers waiting for slow system responses.	Directly increases call time without adding value.
Overproduction	Creating very detailed notes for simple issues.	Uses agent time with little benefit.
Overprocessing	Documenting the same information in two separate tools.	Duplicates work and extends wrap-up.
Defects	Incorrect notes leading to follow-up calls and rework.	Increases total handling time across multiple calls.
Skills	Senior agents doing basic password reset calls.	High-skill time is used on low-value tasks.

Conclusion

Many minutes of AHT are tied up in waste rather than true value-added work from the customer’s point of view. In the Improve phase, ideas like simpler screens, clear note templates, and better routing of basic calls to junior agents can directly attack these wastes and reduce AHT. [web:599][web:549]